pending in Congress and there wouldn’t be any mandatory quotas.”

Not long after the meeting with Foreign Minister Ito, I got a call from Al Haig, who was extremely upset over a decision I’d made naming George Bush as chairman of a special group within the National Security Council that would help me manage affairs during an international crisis. In the past, the president’s national security advisor had generally served as chairman of the White House crisis management team. But Haig didn’t like or trust National Security Advisor Richard Allen. I had discussed the matter with the top three staff people in the White House, Jim Baker, Ed Meese, and Mike Deaver, and we’d come up with the plan giving the responsibility to George Bush. Not only would that deal with Haig’s unhappiness over Allen; I also thought that it was prudent—and important for the country—for the vice-president to play as large a role in the affairs of the administration as possible; I didn’t want George, in the words of Nelson Rockefeller, simply to be “standby equipment.”

Now Haig was on the phone going through the roof, saying he didn’t want the vice-president to have *anything* to do with international affairs; it was *his* jurisdiction, he said, and he told me he was thinking of resigning. I couldn’t understand why he was so upset, and I told him he had nothing to worry about.

I thought he was seeing shadows in a mirror. No one wanted to invade his turf. But early the next morning, I was awakened by a call from Mike Deaver, who said Haig had raised a fuss with the staff the night before over George’s new assignment and was threatening to submit his resignation that day.

I invited Haig to the Oval Office at eight forty-five, expecting his offer of resignation and intending to try to talk him out of it. But when he arrived, he was cool-headed and